DIHWorld Audio - Cascading Effects Bus Template

Effects -> Width -> Color -> Collection -> Master | Enhanced for ANKH family placement Enhanced: 2026-10-19

User authority: `DIHWorld_Audio_Complete_Manual_CURRENT.pdf`

Current product behavior: ANUBIS has a named stereo Sidechain bus with separate Key/Duck functions; DEBO uses the balanced canonical bank; TRIPLER uses the repaired clean left/right harmony path; SESHAT named views hide unrelated panels; AU and Drum Morpher are current registered instruments.

Use this when a session needs three deliberate parallel lanes feeding one clean collection point. The buses carry the work; source tracks stay lean.

Core Operating Law

- Start buses and sends around -18 dB as a safe audition point, not a fixed operating target.
- In normal use, many DIH processors will feel optimal around -14 to -10 dB, depending on source, family, and FieldState.
- Some plugins operate cleanly at unity when the use case supports it; approve unity only after bypass/output matching and no clipping, ringing, or level jump.
- Output-match to bypass before approving tone, width, spatial placement, or loudness.
- Use up to three active processors on a track or bus. More than three is an audition rack, not a committed mix chain. For Color and Effects, the normal committed choice is one primary stage or independent parallel returns.
- SESHAT is observation only and may sit last on the print/master endpoint.
- Presets never control Input, Output, Mix, Bypass, or protected ceiling/safety controls.
- Keep each plugin in its primary family when possible; if moved, it replaces a slot instead of extending the chain.
- SLOTMACHINE is always last in any chain that uses it. ANKH is the containment authority.

Architecture

```
SOURCE TRACKS
  Send 1 start -18 dB -> EFFECTS BUS [FX_SPATIAL]
  Send 2 start -18 dB -> WIDTH BUS   [DIMENSIONAL_IMPACT_MOVE]
  Send 3 start -18 dB -> COLOR BUS   [COLOR_AMP_TAPE]
  Optimize commonly toward -14 to -10 dB; unity is valid only when clean.

EFFECTS BUS + WIDTH BUS + COLOR BUS
  -> COLLECTION CHANNEL              [no inserts, summing only]
  -> PRINT / MASTER BUS
  -> Stereo Out
```

Bus Chains

Bus	Three-active starter chain	Substitutions / notes
EFFECTS BUS	Independent 100% wet NTRSTLLR, Cathedral, and SacredVerb returns	Choose the return for the required space; do not serially stack reverbs. Route the chosen returns to COLLECTION.
WIDTH BUS	DEPTH_IMPACT_HYBRID_X **or** PARALLAX **or** NSR	Choose one primary width move. SERQET replaces PARALLAX for a creative move; it does not extend the chain. Mono-check before print.

Bus	Three-active starter chain	Substitutions / notes
COLOR BUS	`Chain: Music Bus Foundation` in KHEPRI -> APIS	PTAHTUBE or SOVEREIGN replaces APIS when a second color voice is required; do not run all three by default.
COLLECTION	No inserts	Collection is a summing point only. If it needs tone, the tone belongs on a lane above or the print bus below.

Print / Master Choices

Use case	Active chain	When
Clean	SPHYNX -> MAAT -> ANKH -> SESHAT	Prepare, balance, contain, then observe.
Authority	PLATINUM -> IMHOTEP -> ANKH -> SESHAT	Master authority plus macro field structure.
Loud / modern	SPHYNX -> HORIZON_X -> ANKH -> SESHAT	Lift and finish before containment.
Dimensional	DEPTH_IMPACT_HYBRID_X -> MAAT -> ANKH -> SESHAT	Front/back placement before balance and containment.
Color master	KHEPRI or SOVEREIGN -> MAAT -> ANKH -> SESHAT	One color stage, one balance stage, then containment.

Factory Recall

Use `06_Optimized_Preset_Recall_Map_CURRENT.md` for the exact current-program names. The Color Bus default is `Chain: Music Bus Foundation` in KHEPRI; `ACOUSTIC CLARITY [Stereo]` in WPR is its transformer/ribbon alternative, not an additional insert.

Send Discipline

From	To	Level	Rule
Every source track	EFFECTS BUS	Start -18; -14 to -10 usual; unity clean	Spatial material only. Do not hide color or dynamics here.
Every source track	WIDTH BUS	Start -18; -14 to -10 usual; unity clean	Width/depth moves only. Collapse-check before printing.
Every source track	COLOR BUS	Start -18; -14 to -10 usual; unity clean	Harmonic color lane. Pick three active processors maximum.
All buses	COLLECTION	unity route	No inserts on collection.

Output Approval

- Match the delivery specification for the project or platform; this template does not impose a fixed RMS, peak, or crest target.
- Preserve musical dynamics and confirm zero unintended clipping.
- Compare at matched loudness before approving the print.